



Punjab Kings acquired Vyshak Vijaykumar for ₹1.80 crore during the IPL 2025 mega auction. He has repaid that faith as a vital component of its pace battery.



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International call-up for the fast-approaching South Africa series.

Almost as if fate wanted to underline the moment, on the very next day, he reached a personal landmark, picking his 100th First-Class wicket while playing for Karnataka in a Ranji Trophy outing against Bihar. It would seem the stars were finally aligning.

He eventually didn't get a game in the Rainbow Nation, but the proverbial door was finally ajar. Or so Vyshak would have thought, before an all-too-familiar twist forced its way into the tale. An untimely quadriceps injury in the early months of 2025 dragged him back, halting his momentum just as it had begun to gather impetus.

"Emotionally, it is very important to not dwell on it. You'd be letting yourself down. Injuries are a part of cricket. Everybody gets injured. I have a great family. When I go back home, they are always supportive. They asked me not to worry. In this profession, you don't get a lot of time off to spend with your family. So, I just interpreted it as a manner of God giving me things that I otherwise wouldn't have got," Vyshak, who then spent two months in rehabilitation at the BCCI's Centre of Excellence, tells *Sportstar*.

In the meantime, Punjab Kings made a move right after Vyshak returned from South Africa, acquiring the pacer's services for ₹1.80 crore during the IPL 2025 mega auction. When the season began, there was hardly anyone who predicted Vyshak to be a regular starter. However, as it turned out, he didn't have to wait long for his moment in the sun.

Interestingly, Vyshak himself was unaware that he would be summoned during PBKS' opening game as an Impact Player until 13 overs into the Gujarat Titans' chase.

With Sherfane Rutherford and Jos Buttler wreaking havoc in the middle, coach Ricky Ponting sent a worried message out to captain Shreyas Iyer on the field. The PBKS skipper replied almost instinctively: "Just get Vyshak out here. He will nail a couple of overs of yorkers, and we will close the game."

Marcus Stoinis had just conceded 17 runs in the 14th over when Vyshak was handed the ball. GT needed 75 from 36. "We just thought we would try a few wide yorkers. I ended up bowling a couple of wides as well. But Shreyas

